

casting are an integral part of dictatorships. The governments prohibit messages from outside by jamming broadcasts and forbidding printed material from entering the country. That doesn't work in an Internet world. The student revolt in China was coordinated by data network. Tiananmen Square was cleared by troops, but the ideas of an open society remain.

What will be the next transforming technology? The Internet would have to head the list.

MANUFACTURING

When a minor bug was discovered in the Intel Pentium microprocessor chip, Intel tried to downplay the fault, but an enormous protest over the Internet forced a product recall.

PUBLISHING

The drawback with technical journals has always been the delay between the cry of "Eureka!" in the laboratory and the date of publication. It took time to write an article and have a journal accept, edit, and distribute it. In a fast-moving field, who wants to wait two years to receive the latest research? Today, researchers put their work on the Internet first. By the time the journal article or PhD thesis is finally published, all the people who need to know about it saw it the year before. The published journal is flipped into the library as archival material, not circulated for careful reading. Companies that publish trade journals realize that they have been marginalized, and so are trying to find a new role as editors of on-line papers.